

Main

Report Name (Org_Country_Year_Report Type)

ESP_Côte d'Ivoire_2024-25_3-month Report

Fellowship Organization

Entrepreneurial Solutions Partners (ESP)

Fellowship City

Abidjan

Fellowship Country

Côte d'Ivoire

Fellowship Start Date

08/30/2024

Anticipated Fellowship End Date

08/29/2025

What is your fellowship title/role?

Growth and Insight Fellow

What are your primary responsibilities?

Update of databases – Inventory

o Cv

o Biographies

o Experiences tables

o Project sheets

o Reference letters

- Proposal writing

o Process mastery

o Methodologies mastery

o Writing narratives

o Proofreading

- Product sheets design / content

o Climate Hub

o Cluster for Scale

- Participation in sales missions

o Ppt preparation

o Ppt presentation

- Process compliance

o Confidentiality

o ODOO

I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.

Agree

Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?

Yes

Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.

HR sent a schedule to meet all departments.

If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?**Describe a representative day at work.**

My day starts with meeting with my manager or the person I'm collaborating on a project. We touch base on the evolution of the task at hand and agree on next steps. Then I usually keep working on the project, I interact with different team members who have information I need to complete it.

On average, how many hours per week do you work?

45

How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?

Neutral

Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.

Climate Hub: a pioneering initiative that ESP is preparing to launch that involves adapting climate considerations in its practice for assisting entrepreneurs and the private sector for economic development.

Internal awareness action: ESP received feedback from the wider team that there was a disconnect and people were out of the loop with the climate hub. along with a colleague, we were charged with creating an action plan that would onboard our team to ESP's climate transition as a whole via the climate hub initiative. The action plan is now being implemented.

What is your organization's work culture like?

What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.

There are various locations where one can take its computer and work. My office is an open space office with 18 open cubicles. Usually, only four or five of us are up there. Sometimes I use closed meeting rooms for extra focus. The office is a re-adapted house There is AC.

To whom do you report?

-Growth Lead

-Growth Director

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?

Yes

Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.

Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.

1. Grow in self-confidence: not second-guessing and doubting myself at work
2. Leading a project from the stage of it being a lead to closing a contract
3. Mastering the diligence of following through

How often do you check in with your supervisor?

Daily

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

Yes

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).

I assisted in terms of writing the report of a firm where we held a strategic alignment workshop in Assinie.

I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.

Neutral

Please briefly explain your response.

Its a new field. I have the basic skills to make it, but still on the learning learning

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

My Organization bought my tickets so I don't have information on the price. I flew from my home country Kinshasa DRC, directly into Abidjan CI

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

Visitor

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

Work handled it

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

Bought before, printed at arrival

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

Work paid

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

Covered by org

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

No

If yes, please explain further

g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

Remind them to ask all visa questions during interviews with PiAf staff and the org they want to go to

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

None required

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

As improvements, I would ask PiAF to make it an agreement between the org and the Fellowship program to have all our information regarding incoming flight and accommodation a minimum of two weeks before a fellow is due to arrive in the country. Because I received my information less than 24 hours before I took my plane.

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

Work found and paid for

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Very Urban

Please describe your living environment

Apartment

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

I use an equivalent to Uber here called Yango. My daily commute to and from work is about \$13 per day. My commute time in the morning is between 15 to 20 minutes my commute time going back from work to my place is between 45 min to an hour.

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

n/a

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?
The weather is tropical. It is humid and hot. We are in the rainy season now.

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

For work business casual is appropriate. In general, modesty is also observed but European dressing standards are seen here and there.

How have you been spending your free time?

In my free time, I have been reading and cooking. As far as socializing work, ESP organizes some networking events, which help me know my colleagues better. I connected with a church community which has allowed me to participate in weekly events for socializing.

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Neutral

Please briefly explain your response below.

Still trying to balance work and social life and timezones

Yes safe no crime

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

Chared and connected phone

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

None

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

N/A

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

In terms of the first goal, I am definitely getting an understanding of consulting work in Africa. It is the two other goals, exploring Abidjan to have fun and during connections for a lifetime that are a bit more challenging. My church community is helping me connect and form relationships, but exploring and navigating the city until it's home with my busy schedule at work has been challenging.

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

No

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

No

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

No

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

The cultural expressions that I enjoy learning

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

Time management to explore the city

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

Gyms that open at 4 AM, a dryer, and affordability of self-care products.

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

The weather, culture, and infrastructure compared to the DRC.

How is your stipend being paid?

Monthly in local account in local currency

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

Wire

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

No

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$0.00	\$-0.01	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$400.00	\$0.00	\$100.00	\$500.00	\$0.00	\$100.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$800.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	0.00
Specify "Other"					

Final Thoughts

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

Good orientation

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

N/A

Are you receiving sufficient support, materials and information from the Princeton in Africa office? What could we improve?

Sufficient support

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)

Address time management with practical tools